NEW ELEMENT
A NetZero 2050 campus with 95,000+ trees, social outreach spans 800,000 people, including 12 villages

research ecosystem. Over 652 funded research projects worth over Rs 286 crore have been undertaken, supported by agencies like the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR), Department of Science & Technology (DST) and the Royal Norwegian Embassy.

Entrepreneurship thrives here. The Bootstrappers' Research Council, part of the Startup India Seed Fund Scheme, has secured Rs 3 crore in funding from DPIIT; the Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council (BIRAC) has sanctioned Rs 10 crore for medical startups. Success stories include Abinava Rizel, an electric vehicle (EV) powertrain

TOP 5

PRIVATE UNIVERSITIES WITH THE HIGHEST NUMBER OF PATENTS GRANTED IN THE PAST THREE YEARS

RANK	UNIVERSITY	NO. OF PATENTS
1	CHITKARA UNIVERSITY, PATIALA	640
2	AMITY UNIVERSITY UTTAR PRADESH, NOIDA	316
3	SRM INSTITUTE OF SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY, KATTANKULATHUR, CHENNAI	281
4	KONERU LAKSHMAIAH EDUCATION FOUNDATION (DEEMED TO BE UNIVERSITY), GUNTUR	275
5	SATHYABAMA INSTITUTE OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY (DEEMED TO BE UNIVERSITY), CHENNAI	206

GUEST COLUMN



PROF. C. MUTHAMIZHCHELVAN
Vice-Chancellor, SRMIST

A Wholesome Experience

I have been associated with SRMIST since its inception as an affiliated college in 1985. Our commitment remains rooted in three pillars: academic rigour, innovation and social impact. In the past year, we have introduced programmes in cutting-edge areas like AI, robotics, digital health, quantum computing, climate science and clean energy. We also run forward-looking courses on design thinking, innovation, intellectual property rights, and entrepreneurship. Faculty training has been key. We have invested heavily in capacity-building, conducting training in-house and sending our faculty to universities here and abroad to learn best practices. While this is an ongoing process, it has already transformed the quality of teaching at SRMIST.

Our students benefit from the multidisciplinary nature of the institute. Students are encouraged to take courses beyond their core disciplines, broadening their perspectives. Campus life is equally vibrant, and we have a large number of student clubs. With 18,000 students living on campus, SRMIST offers a 24/7 immersive environment. Our sports facilities are world-class; our international-standard swimming pool gallery is named after Nethra Kumanan, a current student who became India's first woman to represent the country at the Olympics in Sailing.

Research is a cornerstone of SRMIST. Our labs are open 24/7, and we encourage both discipline-specific and interdisciplinary research. We have established an Innovation Centre and an Idea Clinic, where students can post problem statements and collaborate on solutions. We classify research under five pillars: Environment, Energy, Water, Healthcare, and Disruptive Technologies. To date, SRMIST holds 485 granted patents, paving the way for technology transfers and product development.

In the past six years, around 100 startups have graduated from our incubation ecosystem. A notable example is Abinava Rizel, which designs electric motors for electric vehicles. After two years of incubation support, including space, patent filing, and funding, they recently secured Rs 200 crore in funding. One of our proudest achievements is our alumni network. Sriram Krishnan, who graduated in 2005, is now Senior Policy Advisor for Artificial Intelligence in the Trump administration. ■

"The multidisciplinary nature of the institute helps students. They are encouraged to take courses beyond their core disciplines"